

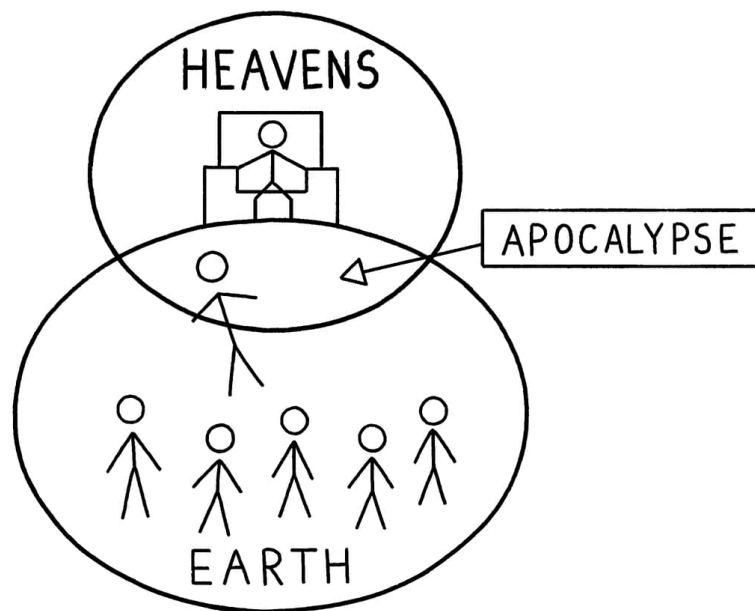
Session 3: Paul's Apocalypse

Key Takeaways

- According to the Bible, Heaven and Earth are distinct but not separate realities.
- An apocalypse is when the bond between Heaven and Earth becomes visible to us.
- Paul experiences his own apocalypse when Jesus reveals himself as the risen Messiah and calls Paul to share this revelation with others. This encounter is foundational to the book of Ephesians.
- Ephesians is an invitation to experience the risen Jesus and allow that apocalypse to transform us.

The Heavens and the Earth

In the biblical worldview, the heavens and the earth are distinct but not separate realities. When Paul encounters Jesus ([Acts 9:1-6](#), [22:6-7](#), [26:13-18](#)), God reveals this bond between Heaven and Earth to Paul in a way that transforms his assumptions about what God is doing in the world.



The Overlapping of Heaven and Earth. Illustration created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Paul's Letter to the Ephesians (2019).

Reflection Question

According to the biblical worldview, are Heaven and Earth distinct spaces? Why is this important for understanding a biblical apocalypse?